

TOO MANY COOKS

# Marketplace + Chef Profile Blueprint

A practical product and design brief for everything after the customer enters the marketplace: discovery, trust, ordering, and the chef workspace behind it.

**Customers arrive hungry. They discover a meal first, then the cook and story behind it.**

Product direction brief · September 2026

Based on the current Expo + Supabase app and the marketplace brainstorm

## 01 · NORTH STAR

## What the customer experience should do

The marketplace should help a customer go from “I want something good” to “I know what I’m ordering, who made it, and how I’ll get it” with as little friction as possible.

**Core principle:** meals lead the page; cook identity and trust information travel with every meal.

### Customer default

Customer login opens the marketplace at **/discover**, with search ready immediately.

### Chef default

Chef login opens the existing menu workspace at **/(cook)/meals**. The dashboard remains available, but is secondary.

### Customer navigation

Market, Saved, Orders, Account.

### Chef navigation

My Menu, Orders, Account. Market and Saved stay customer-only.

### Success looks like

- A customer can search by meal, cook, cuisine, or craving.
- A customer can understand availability, price, pickup/delivery, and next action from a card.
- A customer can trust a cook through identity, location, cuisine, ratings, and profile story.
- A chef can publish a dish, manage availability, view orders, and maintain a credible profile.
- A user with both roles can choose Customer or Chef after sign-in.

## 02 · MARKETPLACE

# The customer page

Make the first screen feel like a lively local food market rather than a database browser.

### First viewport

1. **Warm discovery header:** “What are you craving today?”
2. **Primary search:** “Search dishes, cooks, or cuisines.”
3. **Location:** a visible city/location selector such as Philadelphia.
4. **Availability signal:** “12 cooks nearby” or the current live count.
5. **Quick discovery chips:** Comfort food, Weeknight dinner, Vegetarian, Desserts, Meal prep, New this week.

### Mobile order

#### 1. Search and location

Search is the first action. Location sets realistic results.

#### 2. Browse by craving

Chips make discovery possible when the customer has a mood, not a dish name.

#### 3. Popular near you

Lead with meals that are available now and close enough to fulfill.

#### 4. Cooks you may like

Introduce personality and encourage following.

#### 5. Fresh from the kitchen

Newly published dishes create a reason to return.

#### 6. Followed cooks

Personalized repeat behavior for customers who come back.

### Desktop order

Use a compact filter rail on the left and a meal-first discovery grid on the right. Keep cook details attached to each meal. Move full cook browsing to a dedicated cook profile route instead of making the main page behave like a split database panel.

03 · SEARCH + DISCOVERY

# Make search feel forgiving

The current search model already supports meal names, cook names, cuisines, categories, and distributed matches. The UI should make that power legible.

| Customer intent | Search example | Response                                           |
|-----------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Specific dish   | “jollof rice”  | Show matching meals and their cooks.               |
| Cuisine         | “Indian food”  | Normalize “food” and match cuisine/category terms. |
| Mood or need    | “spicy dinner” | Match categories, descriptions, and craving chips. |
| Person          | “Amara”        | Show the cook profile and current menu.            |

## Controls

Use friendly language: Available now instead of “In stock only.” Allow a clear “Include sold out” alternative. Keep refresh visible but secondary. Show the active query as a removable filter.

## Empty, loading, and error states

|                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Empty</b></p> <p>“No cooks found for ‘ramen’ yet. Try tacos, vegetarian, dessert, or meal prep.”</p>              | <p><b>Loading</b></p> <p>Use skeleton meal and cook cards rather than a single “Loading marketplace...” line.</p>                    |
| <p><b>Offline/API error</b></p> <p>“We couldn’t refresh the market. Your last results are still here.” Offer retry.</p> | <p><b>Preview data</b></p> <p>Keep demo data useful in development, but label it clearly and never present it as live inventory.</p> |

## 04 · MEAL CARDS

# The conversion surface

Every meal card should answer the customer's practical questions before they tap.

**Card anatomy:** real food image · meal name · cook name · location · short description · price · availability · fulfillment timing · primary action.

## Example

### Jollof Rice

\$18

Amara Kitchen · Philadelphia

Smoky tomato rice, plantains, and grilled chicken.

8 available

Pickup today

**Primary action:** View meal

## What to build next

- ☐ Use real meal photography as the dominant visual whenever a photo exists.
- ☐ Add a clear “View meal” action that leads to the existing meal detail and checkout path.
- ☐ Expose pickup, cook delivery, or platform delivery in plain language.
- ☐ Show quantity and timing without making the card feel like inventory software.
- ☐ Keep follow and full-menu actions on the cook surface, not competing with the meal purchase action.

## 05 · COOK IDENTITY

# The chef profile

The chef profile is the trust layer. Customers are choosing a kitchen, not only a menu item.

### Profile header

#### Identity

Cook name, profile image or kitchen image, verification badge, rating, review count.

#### Place

City or neighborhood, fulfillment radius, pickup/delivery options.

#### Point of view

Short bio, cuisines, cooking style, and what makes this kitchen distinct.

#### Proof

Completed orders, repeat customer rate, food-safety badge, and transparent new-cook status.

### Profile actions

**View menu** should be the primary action. **Follow cook** is secondary and should update immediately. A customer should also be able to browse the cook's public menu, view a meal, and return to the marketplace without losing their search context.

### Voice

Keep the writing human and specific. "Small-batch meals with big Sunday-dinner energy" is more persuasive than "high-quality food service."

**06 · CHEF WORKSPACE**

# The chef profile and menu builder

Chef login should open My Menu. The existing dashboard remains useful, but the chef's first job is to make something customers can buy.

## Chef navigation

### My Menu

Create meals, edit drafts, upload photos, set prices and quantities, publish or hide items, view public menu, share menu link.

### Orders

See new orders, accept or decline, manage ready/completed status, and view customer/order details.

### Account

Chef profile, kitchen identity, city, bio, cuisines, availability, verification, legal/compliance details.

## Menu item creation

1. Title and food photo
2. Description that makes the dish sound good
3. Food categories and cuisine
4. Price and quantity available
5. Service type: prepared meal, meal prep, or in-home chef
6. Fulfillment: pickup, cook delivery, or platform delivery
7. Availability window and lead time
8. Draft, preview, publish, and hide states

## Chef profile completion

- ☐ Display name and kitchen name
- ☐ Bio, cuisine tags, cook type, and service area
- ☐ Profile image or kitchen image
- ☐ Availability and fulfillment settings
- ☐ Food handler permit and compliance attestations where required
- ☐ Public menu slug and shareable menu link

07 · DATA + ROUTES

Functional contracts

| Flow              | Expected destination           | Definition of done                                         |
|-------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Customer sign-in  | /(customer)/discover           | Marketplace loads; search and live cooks/meals are usable. |
| Chef sign-in      | /(cook)/meals                  | My Menu loads; chef can create, edit, publish, and share.  |
| Dual-role sign-in | /(auth)/choose-profile         | Customer and Chef choices route independently.             |
| Meal click        | /meals/[mealId]                | Customer sees detail, availability, and checkout action.   |
| Cook click        | /cooks/[cookId] or public menu | Customer sees identity, trust, menu, and follow state.     |

Core data the marketplace needs

**Cook:** display name, bio, city, cuisines, cook types, verification, ratings, follower count, active state.

**Meal:** title, description, photo, price, quantity, categories, service type, fulfillment modes, published state, updated time, cook identity.

**Customer state:** follows, saved meals, recent searches, orders, selected location.

**08 · BUILD ORDER**

# What to focus on next

**1 Lock the role flows.**

Customer → marketplace. Chef → My Menu. Dual role → chooser.

**2 Make the marketplace meal-first.**

Improve cards, images, availability, location, and the View meal action.

**3 Finish the chef profile and menu loop.**

A chef must be able to represent their kitchen, publish a dish, and see the public result.

**4 Make search and empty states feel intentional.**

Customers should never be confused by zero results, loading, sold-out items, or API errors.

**5 Only then add polish.**

Motion, typography, photography, refined spacing, and responsive desktop composition.

## Acceptance checklist

- ☐ Customer can search by dish, cuisine, cook, or craving.
- ☐ Customer can filter available meals and understand fulfillment.
- ☐ Customer can follow a cook and browse that cook's menu.
- ☐ Customer can open meal detail and continue toward checkout.
- ☐ Chef can create and publish a meal with complete information.
- ☐ Chef can edit, hide, and share a public menu.
- ☐ Chef can view orders and update order status.
- ☐ Customer and chef navigation never expose the wrong role's primary tabs.

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This blueprint is intentionally product-focused. It describes the experience to build on top of the existing Expo Router, Supabase Auth, meals, profiles, follows, orders, and storage foundations.